

Radicals Two Ways — Answer Key

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Part A

1) $3\sqrt{3} - 2\sqrt{12} + 4\sqrt{\frac{1}{3}}$

$$3\sqrt{3} - 2(2\sqrt{3}) + 4 \cdot \frac{1}{\sqrt{3}} = 3\sqrt{3} - 4\sqrt{3} + \frac{4\sqrt{3}}{3}$$

$$= (3 - 4 + \frac{4}{3})\sqrt{3} = \frac{1}{3}\sqrt{3}$$

$$\frac{\sqrt{3}}{3}$$

2) $8\sqrt{10} - 3\sqrt{40} + 5\sqrt{\frac{1}{10}}$

$$8\sqrt{10} - 6\sqrt{10} + \frac{5}{\sqrt{10}} = 2\sqrt{10} + \frac{\sqrt{10}}{2}$$

$$\frac{5\sqrt{10}}{2}$$

3) $2\sqrt{\frac{7}{2}} + 4\sqrt{\frac{7}{8}} - \frac{1}{2}\sqrt{98}$

$$2 \cdot \frac{\sqrt{14}}{2} + 4 \cdot \frac{\sqrt{14}}{4} - \frac{7\sqrt{2}}{2} = 2\sqrt{14} - \frac{7\sqrt{2}}{2}$$

$$\frac{4\sqrt{14} - 7\sqrt{2}}{2}$$

4) $3\sqrt{\frac{5}{12}} + \sqrt{\frac{12}{5}} - \frac{1}{3}\sqrt{60}$ two-way!

$$\frac{\sqrt{15}}{2} + \frac{2\sqrt{15}}{5} - \frac{2\sqrt{15}}{3} \quad (\text{LCD } 30)$$

$$= \frac{15\sqrt{15} + 12\sqrt{15} - 20\sqrt{15}}{30}$$

$$\frac{7\sqrt{15}}{30}$$

5) $5\sqrt{3}(\sqrt{6} + 2\sqrt{8})$

$$5\sqrt{18} + 10\sqrt{24} = 5(3\sqrt{2}) + 10(2\sqrt{6})$$

$$15\sqrt{2} + 20\sqrt{6}$$

6) $5\sqrt{2}(4\sqrt{8} - 2\sqrt{12})$

$$20\sqrt{16} - 10\sqrt{24} = 20(4) - 10(2\sqrt{6})$$

$$80 - 20\sqrt{6}$$

7) $2\sqrt{49x^3} - 3\sqrt{16x^3}$

$$2 \cdot 7x\sqrt{x} - 3 \cdot 4x\sqrt{x} = 14x\sqrt{x} - 12x\sqrt{x}$$

$$2x\sqrt{x}$$

8) $4\sqrt{72s^4} - 2s\sqrt{200s^2}$

$$4 \cdot s^2 \cdot 6\sqrt{2} - 2s \cdot s \cdot 10\sqrt{2} = 24s^2\sqrt{2} - 20s^2\sqrt{2}$$

$$4s^2\sqrt{2}$$

9) $\sqrt{\frac{x^2}{16} + \frac{x^2}{25}}$

$$\sqrt{\frac{25x^2 + 16x^2}{400}} = \sqrt{\frac{41x^2}{400}} = \frac{x\sqrt{41}}{20}$$

$$\frac{x\sqrt{41}}{20}$$

10) $\sqrt{\frac{x^2}{49} - \frac{x^2}{121}}$

$$\sqrt{\frac{121x^2 - 49x^2}{5929}} = \sqrt{\frac{72x^2}{5929}} = \frac{x \cdot 6\sqrt{2}}{77}$$

$$\frac{6x\sqrt{2}}{77}$$

Part B

11) $\sqrt{\frac{x^2}{a^2} + \frac{x^2}{b^2}}$

$$\sqrt{\frac{b^2x^2+a^2x^2}{a^2b^2}} = \frac{x}{ab}\sqrt{a^2+b^2}$$

$$\frac{x\sqrt{a^2+b^2}}{ab}$$

12) $\frac{1}{\sqrt{2}} + \frac{1}{\sqrt{3}}$ (two-way!)

Way 1: $\frac{\sqrt{2}}{2} + \frac{\sqrt{3}}{3} = \frac{3\sqrt{2}+2\sqrt{3}}{6}$

$$\frac{3\sqrt{2} + 2\sqrt{3}}{6}$$

13) $\frac{3}{\sqrt{5}} - \frac{2}{\sqrt{15}}$

$$\frac{3\sqrt{5}}{5} - \frac{2\sqrt{15}}{15} = \frac{9\sqrt{5}-2\sqrt{15}}{15}$$

$$\frac{9\sqrt{5} - 2\sqrt{15}}{15}$$

14) $\sqrt{\frac{2}{3}} + \sqrt{\frac{3}{2}}$ (two-way!)

$$\frac{\sqrt{6}}{3} + \frac{\sqrt{6}}{2} = \frac{2\sqrt{6}+3\sqrt{6}}{6}$$

$$\frac{5\sqrt{6}}{6}$$

15) $2\sqrt{\frac{1}{8}} + \sqrt{\frac{1}{2}}$

$$\frac{2}{2\sqrt{2}} + \frac{1}{\sqrt{2}} = \frac{1}{\sqrt{2}} + \frac{1}{\sqrt{2}} = \frac{2}{\sqrt{2}}$$

$$\sqrt{2}$$

16) $\sqrt{8} + \sqrt{18} - \sqrt{2}$

$$2\sqrt{2} + 3\sqrt{2} - \sqrt{2}$$

$$4\sqrt{2}$$

17) $\sqrt{20} - \sqrt{45} + \sqrt{80}$

$$2\sqrt{5} - 3\sqrt{5} + 4\sqrt{5}$$

$$3\sqrt{5}$$

18) $(\sqrt{3} + \sqrt{2})(\sqrt{3} - \sqrt{2})$

Conjugates: $3 - 2$

$$1$$

19) $(2\sqrt{5} + \sqrt{3})^2$

$$(2\sqrt{5})^2 + 2(2\sqrt{5})(\sqrt{3}) + (\sqrt{3})^2 = 20 + 4\sqrt{15} + 3$$

$$23 + 4\sqrt{15}$$

★ 20) $4\sqrt{\frac{5}{6}} - \sqrt{\frac{3}{10}}$ (the Kenny problem)

WAY 1 — Rationalize each FIRST, then combine

$$\begin{aligned} & \frac{4\sqrt{5}}{\sqrt{6}} \cdot \frac{\sqrt{6}}{\sqrt{6}} - \frac{\sqrt{3}}{\sqrt{10}} \cdot \frac{\sqrt{10}}{\sqrt{10}} \\ &= \frac{4\sqrt{30}}{6} - \frac{\sqrt{30}}{10} = \frac{2\sqrt{30}}{3} - \frac{\sqrt{30}}{10} \end{aligned}$$

$$\text{LCD } 30: \frac{20\sqrt{30}-3\sqrt{30}}{30} = \frac{17\sqrt{30}}{30}$$

WAY 2 — Build $\sqrt{30}$ common denom FIRST, rationalize LAST

$$\frac{4\sqrt{5}}{\sqrt{6}} \cdot \frac{\sqrt{5}}{\sqrt{5}} - \frac{\sqrt{3}}{\sqrt{10}} \cdot \frac{\sqrt{3}}{\sqrt{3}}$$

$$= \frac{20}{\sqrt{30}} - \frac{3}{\sqrt{30}} = \frac{17}{\sqrt{30}}$$

$$= \frac{17}{\sqrt{30}} \cdot \frac{\sqrt{30}}{\sqrt{30}} = \frac{17\sqrt{30}}{30}$$

$$\frac{17\sqrt{30}}{30}$$

Both ways → same answer ✓